



LETTER CAMPAIGN

To deal urgently with burning issues in the **war on terror**, we now call on you to write directly to the **Minister for Home Affairs** and seek decisive action.

Shri P. Chidambaram, Union Minister for Home Affairs, New Delhi
Honourable Minister,

I have joined the INDIA TODAY Group's movement to Declare War on Terror. Post-Mumbai, the cracks in our security structure stand seriously exposed. A complete revamp of the police force, especially at the metro level, is now top priority. The National Police Mission, announced by the Prime Minister in October 2005 to empower and equip the police to effectively take up the challenges thrown by terrorism, remains in deep freeze. I humbly request you to implement police reforms proposed by the Mission on an urgent basis. As a beginning, you could get the states to upgrade the existing police stations and provide better equipment. The nation needs an alert and responsive police to fight the war on terror. We are banking on you to deliver.

Yours sincerely
Concerned Citizen of India
(Sign here)

Write to P. Chidambaram on your letterhead and send it to:
Ministry of Home Affairs,
North Block, Central Secretariat, New Delhi - 110 001 Or
email: hm@nic.in

You can also go to www.indiatoday.in/war and send it from there.

Citizen's Charter: Other Ways You Can Help

Turn your concern into action. **FIVE** simple things you can do now, that can make a significant impact in our War on Terror:

1 CREATE NODES

Define aggregation points in the neighbourhood where people can collect in emergencies.

2 MAP IT OUT

Develop alternate routes to and from work and school to avoid chaos near terror-hit spots.

3 COME FORWARD

Depose as a witness if you have observed terror attacks.

4 BE PATIENT

Expect delays, baggage searches and restrictions at public places and travel facilities.

5 EMERGENCY PLAN

Develop a family emergency plan, share it with family and friends and practice it.

Share your suggestions, Click to www.indiatoday.in/war or sms WAR with your suggestion, name and city to 52424



India's Views

In view of the Mumbai attacks, here are some suggestions to improve our security. R&AW needs to come under the MEA, with a foolproof system of effective coordination between R&AW and IB, while the IB needs to have an exclusive wing to counter terror. A Central anti-terror command also needs to be set up, free from interference, which should automatically assume full command of state police forces to carry out anti-terror operations. State commandos need to be Centrally-funded. We need a security auditor general to look into our internal security preparedness and apparatus. The Government may also set up a team of security experts to look into the lapses that led to 26/11. Relieve the NSG of VIP protection. Instead of putting state police forces at the beck and call of politicians, make them accountable to law and order. Steal the underworld's thunder by having software experts freeze/divert their funds if there is no support from outside.

S.M. SIVARAMAN, Chennai

How about having a national government comprising all parties for one year? Impose emergency for a limited period to take the War on Terror to its logical end.

MANISH GOYAL, Bhubaneswar

Terrorism has to be deleted from the world. The Government has to take some action now. Only youth can fix this problem.

SATISH KUMAR, Bangalore

Why should our politicians be bothered? They do not face the real problem. It is only the common man, who has to put up with the hardships. If the scourge of terror affects our leaders, they should take some drastic steps, instead of issuing speeches.

LAXMI NARAYAN PADHY, Bhubaneswar